

Google Assistant

Smart displays, Smart homes, Android Auto

Google hasn't been known for a significant presence at past editions of CES. But this year was different, as Google went all out with almost every major hardware manufacturer including the Google Assistant platform in some way in their product. Of the many that generated some of the highest amount of interest, Lenovo's Assistant powered displays that go up against the likes of Amazon's Echo Show are most notable. Rather than being an Android tablet slapped onto a Google Home, the smart displays will work on Android Things at their core. Featuring powerful speakers, these displays are all set to give Amazon Echo a run for its money, along with other alternatives from JBL, LG, and Sony that will feature displays and from Altec Lansing, Anker Innovations, Bang & Olufsen, Klipsch and more without displays.

Other than that, a host of IoT, Security and Home automation platforms have announced support for Google Assistant,

such as Kohler, Gourmia, Crestron, Abode Systems. Traditional set top boxes from Dish and TiVo are all set to become smart with voice-activated Assistant Controls. When you add the fact that Google Assistant has also been announced for a larger lineup of TVs from companies such as LG, TCL, Xiaomi, Haier,



Hisense and more, it makes absolute sense to assume that CES 2018 was Google's way of invading your home. It's even getting in your car, via the Android Auto ecosystem – companies such as Kia and Panasonic are also integrating Google Assistant with their infotainment systems. <http://dgit.in/GAsLenovo>



ASUS ROG Bezel-Free Kit

One of the most interesting things seen at CES this year neither uses dedicated hardware nor software. We are talking about the Bezel-free Kit that ASUS RoG had on display at CES 2018. If you're someone who has a multi-monitor setup and are bothered by the black edges, even with thin-bezel monitors, then this kit promises to be a simple and apparently effective way to get rid of said bezels. Currently, the kit has vertical lenses that go on your screens at 130-degree angles at the edges. At this angle, they refract the light in a way that the images from the two monitors blend to the eye and appear seamless.

According to ASUS, the kit will work with monitors from any brand. As of now they've only been designed for 24 and 25 inch monitors, but ASUS is working on models for bigger monitors as well. The product is expected to be out in 2018, but since it's still a prototype, we haven't seen any additional information on pricing and availability just yet. But when it does come out, it might just be the thing that inspires more people to opt for multi-monitor setups instead of single, ultra-wide displays. That way, you wouldn't lose the flexibility of having three-individual monitors, yet have a kickass display for your rig.